

Monet

Usually seen as the leader of Impressionism, Claude Monet (1840–1926) was the most tenacious and prolific of the group. His influential ideas included an avoidance of black, a reduced palette of bright colours and short, broken brushmarks. Throughout a long career, his fascination with painting light as it appeared in fleeting moments and different weather conditions never diminished. As a central figure in the breakaway from accepted artistic conventions, he exhibited with the Impressionists each year from 1874 to 1879 and again in 1882. Early works included city scenes, gardens, beaches, landscapes, Parisians at their leisure and aspects of the modern, industrial world. In later life he created 'series paintings' – the same scene painted numerous times in changing light and different seasons. In 1883, he bought a house and garden at Giverny, where he created a huge garden, lily pond and Japanese bridge. He painted there almost exclusively for the last 20 years of his life. Many of his later works appear to advance towards abstraction and were a huge influence on succeeding artists.



Monet, *Arrival of the Normandy Train, Gare Saint Lazare*, 1877